

Julio d'Arbelles

TRADE COMPLIANCE · CUSTOMS VALUATION · RULES OF ORIGIN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Supply chain and global trade compliance executive with more than fifteen years of experience across export-manufacturing and cross-border operations in Latin America, including a fifteen-year tenure at Nestlé. Core practice at the intersection of customs valuation and transfer pricing, FTA rules of origin (CAFTA-DR, EU-Central America Association Agreement), suspensive customs regimes, and customs audit defense: led the technical defense of customs valuation audits valued at USD 4M, settled below 0.1% of exposure. WCO-credentialed in Authorized Economic Operator programs. Published practitioner (ICPA Newsletter) on tariff-rate quota administration, preferential origin, and trade-remedy surcharges.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Customs valuation & transfer pricing intersection
- Suspensive customs regimes (inward processing / ATPA)
- Tariff-rate quota administration (WTO / CAFTA-DR)
- AEO certification (WCO SAFE Framework)
- Duty optimization & FTA preference programs
- FTA rules of origin & origin verification defense
- Customs audit defense & post-clearance review
- HS classification & tariff engineering
- Import/export documentation governance
- Trade compliance training & SOP systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Advisor to General Management (Consulting) — Transportation Company, Panama 2026 – Present

- Advise the CEO/General Management team of a USD 3.3M-revenue transport operation (domestic, inland, and cross-border service lines) on tendering, cost governance, and digitalization: led an end-to-end TMS tender from requirements to vendor selection, P&L and per-unit profitability analysis, and KPI dashboard development.

Transport & Foreign Trade Manager — Supermercados Xtra, Panama 2024 – 2025

- Directed transport and foreign trade operations across 58 stores and 3 distribution centers — USD 48M+ in annual imports and a USD 5M transport budget — ensuring imported SKU availability and full customs documentation compliance.
- Delivered USD 300K in annual savings through logistics optimization and customs efficiency; sustained 100% on-time delivery across the network.

Senior Regional Logistics Operations Manager (Contract) — Trade Alliance Corporation, LATAM 2023 – 2024

- Oversaw operations across five LATAM countries for a global fashion retail group, with inbound flows from Spain and the Netherlands; led a team of 15 and delivered USD 200K+ in annual savings through customs and transport negotiations and warehouse optimization.

Foreign Trade Coordinator — Nestlé, Nicaragua 2017 – 2023

- Ensured full trade compliance, documentation governance, and FTA application for export-manufacturing operations exceeding USD 60M annually across six Central American markets; led a team of 10 and served as backup Export Leader for the region (98% OTIF).
- Managed the suspensive customs regime (temporary admission for inward processing), owning inventory accuracy, yield reporting, and regulatory filings.
- Led customs audits and technical defenses: successfully defended customs valuation audits valued at USD 4M, with final settlements of USD 5K and USD 50 — below 0.1% of initial exposure.
- Generated USD 200K+ in annual savings through tariff optimization and FTA preference application (CAFTA-DR and regional agreements).

Compliance Specialist — Nestlé, Nicaragua 2016 – 2017

- Management Representative for the Integrated Management System — three recertifications obtained (ISO 9001, ISO 14001, OHSAS 18001); sole authority for product lot release under GDP; represented the company before labor, social security, and environmental authorities, successfully defending regulatory audits.

Training Specialist • Buyer — Nestlé, Nicaragua

2012 – 2016

- As Buyer, developed sourcing strategies under Nestlé's 7-Step Strategic Sourcing methodology, reducing total cost of ownership through supplier negotiation and global/regional leverage; as Training Specialist, led compliance-mandated training and payroll administration for a 100-employee distribution center and achieved the site's Lean/Six Sigma HR certification.

Plant Accountant & Foreign Trade Compliance Coordinator — Nestlé, Nicaragua

2007 – 2011

- Managed the Temporary Admission Regime for Active Improvement, preparing and submitting all official reports to the Ministry of Economy; oversaw export operations for a factory shipping 95% of production across Central America.
- Controlled import/export documentation, customs broker coordination, fixed-asset lifecycle, fiscal depreciation models, and monthly financial closings.

Trade Analyst & Junior Consultant — CNPE-MIFIC (National Export Promotion Commission), Nicaragua

2006 – 2007

- Analyzed import/export duty-exoneration applications under Law 382; developed 15 technical export projects for SMEs, including HS classification and product documentation, under UNDP-funded programs.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

World Customs Organization — Associate degree, Authorized Economic Operator (AEO), 2023

SIECA — Diploma in Foreign Trade & Customs Operations, 2020

Universidad Iberoamericana de Ciencia y Tecnología — Postgraduate Diploma in Finance, 2012

Universidad Centroamericana, Managua — B.A. Business Administration (International Banking & Finance; International Marketing), 2007

International Trade Centre (ITC) — Export Finance & Payments, 2022

Member, International Compliance Professionals Association (ICPA) • IMS Management Representative (ISO 9001 / ISO 14001 / OHSAS 18001) • Single Windows for Foreign Trade • Export Marketing Strategy

SYSTEMS & TOOLS

SAP (advanced) • Power BI • SQL dashboards • TMS & WMS platforms • SAP Ariba • Infor Nexus • Power Automate • SharePoint • Advanced Excel

PUBLICATIONS

"The Sugar Leaves in Bulk" — ICPA Newsletter, July 2026. Analysis of Central American sugar access to the U.S. market: WTO tariff-rate quota administration versus CAFTA-DR preference, and the compliance impact of the Section 122 balance-of-payments surcharge.

Published analysis on FTA rules of origin, customs valuation and transfer pricing, third-country invoicing, and AEO programs, collected at juliodarbelles.github.io.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) • English (professional working proficiency)